

DECLASSIFIED

01 191252Z RR RR

17/81 MAY 78

FTD WPAFB OH/SDM

TO USAF WASH DC/INMISA

INFO DIA WASH DC/DC-4B/DT-3B

VORAD COC CHEYENNE MTN COMPLEX CO/DOFS

DEPT OF STATE WASH DC/IRS-RM-NPO

USDAO LA PAZ BL

~~CONFIDENTIAL NOT RELEASABLE TO FOREIGN NATIONALS~~

INMISA FOR MR FOLEY.

SUBJECT: MOON DUST (U)

REFERENCES:

A. FBIS PANAMA 142357Z MAY 78 (NOTAL)

B. FBIS ASUNCION PARAGUAY 161931Z MAY 78 (NOTAL)

1. (U) REF A STATED AN OBJECT WAS SEEN TO FALL IN SALTA PROVINCE IN NORTHERN ARGENTINA ON 6 MAY 78. IT IMPACTED ON TAIRE MOUNTAIN IN BOLIVIA, WHERE IT WAS SECURED BY BOLIVIAN AUTHORITIES AND IDENTIFIED AS AN ARTIFICIAL SATELLITE.
2. (U) REF B STATED BOLIVIAN AUTHORITIES BROUGHT THE OBJECT TO THE TOWN OF TARIJA. IT IS SAID TO BE A MECHANICAL DEVICE

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED,  
EFFECTIVE ON 21 SEP 1978  
UNDER AUTHORITY OF  
CHIEF, FTD/SDM.

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NEARLY FOUR METERS IN DIAMETER. REF B ALSO SAID AUTHORITIES HAD REQUESTED AID THROUGH THE CENTRAL GOVERNMENT FROM U.S. NASA TO DETERMINE THE NATURE OF THE OBJECT AND TO INVESTIGATE THE CASE.

3. ~~FOIA~~ FTD COULD POSSIBLY ASSIST IN DETERMINING THE ORIGIN OF THE OBJECT IF IT IS FROM A FOREIGN SPACE SYSTEM. WE ALREADY HAVE REQUESTED THAT NORAD DO A SEARCH TO DETERMINE IF ANY SPACE OBJECT REENTERED NEAR THIS AREA ON 6 MAY 78. THEIR PRELIMINARY SEARCH REVEALED NO SPACE OBJECT REENTERED THE EARTH'S ATMOSPHERE ANYWHERE REMOTELY NEAR THE IMPACT AREA ON 6 MAY 78. TO FURTHER AID US IN IDENTIFYING THE OBJECT, REQUEST ASSISTANCE IN OBTAINING:

A. PHOTOGRAPHY OF OBJECT FROM ALL ANGLES TO INCLUDE CLOSEUPS OF MARKINGS OF ANY TYPE.

B. PHYSICAL DESCRIPTION TO INCLUDE WEIGHT, DIAMETER, COLOR, STRUCTURE, ETC.

C. EXACT TIME OBJECT IMPACTED EARTH.

D. DIRECTION OF TRAVEL BEFORE IMPACT, I.E. NORTH TO SOUTH, ETC.

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E. DESCRIPTION OF THE DESCENT AND THE IMPACT AREA.

4. (U) FTD WOULD HAVE AN INTEREST IN ACQUIRING THE OBJECT IF  
IT IS OF FOREIGN ORIGIN.

COORDINATION:

SDSY *[Signature]* DATE 19 MAY 1976

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